

JOHANNESBURG



Speed Thrills

The Twenty20 World Cup and then the triumph of the Indian team in the tournament, has made sure that the game will spread to other parts of the world as well ("The Future is Here", October 8). The best thing about this form of cricket is that an entire day does not go waste.

A. JACOB SAHAYAM,
Thiruvananthapuram

The T20 World Cup victory, the country's biggest win since 1983, has provided Indian cricket the much needed breather after the 2007 World Cup fiasco. The team has discovered a new breed of champion cricketers who have an iron will and nerves of steel. Though 2-1 at the moment, one hopes the team will succeed in levelling the ongoing one-day series against Australia and prove the

doomsday pandits wrong.
ROHIT BHANDIYE, *Panaji*

Puritans may well turn their nose in distaste, but the fact is that T20 is an engrossing form of cricket. Unless the ICC plans a strategy to revive interest in the lengthier forms of the game, one may as well bid adieu to Test cricket.

PACHU MENON, *Margao*

The inaugural T20 World Cup was engrossing till the very last over and few could have hoped for a more exhilarating finale to an event that has added a brand new dimension to the world of cricket.

J. AKSHOBHYA, *Mysore*

Winner all the Way

The Indian team was able to win the T20 World Cup because of the absence of the three old men ("The Making of Champions", October 8). Had they been present, the result would

surely have been a disaster.
TUNEER BANERJEE, *Kolkata*

The over-the-top victory celebration was proof that the Indian masses and the media are prone to extremities. One wonders what the reaction would have been had Sreesanth dropped the last catch and Pakistan won the game and the Cup.

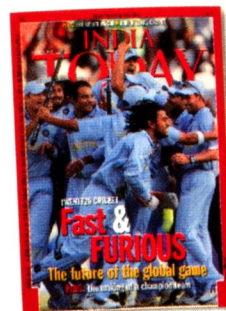
C. SUDHIR, *Chandigarh*

There are a number of lessons to be learnt from this victory. First, no player is indispensable. Second, younger players should be given a chance as they go all out to prove themselves. And third, those playing should also enjoy the game.

R.D. SINGH, *Jammu*

Early Days Yet

After singing paeans to the "Maximum Leader" (August 13), the magazine has now latched on to the rising son ("Sonrise Finally", October 8). Uttar



"Fast and Furious",
October 8, 2007

"Though a great triumph, we need to balance euphoria with reality. We are far from being the champions in other forms of the game."

A.V. KARNIK, *Mumbai*

Pradesh elections have already shown to Rahul Gandhi and his family fiefdom—Congress—what the voters think of them. The media and the hangers-on, however, do not want to face the reality that Rahul is not Rajiv, and that it is not the era when people would be readily swayed by the first family of politics.

ANANT GUPTA, *Delhi*

Bridge to Life

Though the Ram Sethu controversy has infused some life in BJP, the party is still to regain its image of a pro-Hindu party, after the "liberal" Vajpayee inflicted irreparable damage on it in his quest for popularity amongst the minority ("Bridging the Divide", October 8). Advani tried to follow him but he could not succeed as he is out-and-out a BJP man and still remains the best bet for the already battered saffron party.

SHANTI BHUSHAN, *Noida*